Matchplug — Developer Brief

Developer Brief — 6 Oct 2026

One document for the developer and one section for the writer. I checked everything against the live site on 6 Oct 2026: the homepage, the sitemap, the WordPress categories and the last 5 posts.

> **Word version to send:** Matchplug-Developer-Brief-6-Oct-2026.docx

#	Task	Owner	Effort	Priority
1	VIP + Elite results slider (Single ID 182 / 178)	Dev	1–2 days	High
2	Latest News tabs -> content-calendar categories	Dev + Editor	½ day	Medium
3	Internal links: 2 dead links + 7 articles + this week's posts	Dev + Writer	½ day	High
4	Crypto casino section + 8 country pages with paid slots	Dev	4–6 days	Medium
6	Other fixes found during the check	Dev + Writer	1 day	Mixed

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1. Results slider: VIP (Single ID 182) + ELITE (Single ID 178)

Why it has to change

The current **"VIP Results"** block is **hard-coded, not real data.** In the page code, every month (March, April, May, June) shows the same **"15/18 — HUGE PROFIT"**, and every cell shows the same odds of **1.56**. Anyone who looks closely will see it is a template. Months later it still reads "March–June". It also backs up the "Verified VIP track record" claim in the hero, so it is a credibility risk and an advertising-standards risk. Replace it with live data that **includes losses**.

What to build

Data source: the tips/packages backend that already powers the member area (`user.matchplug.com`).

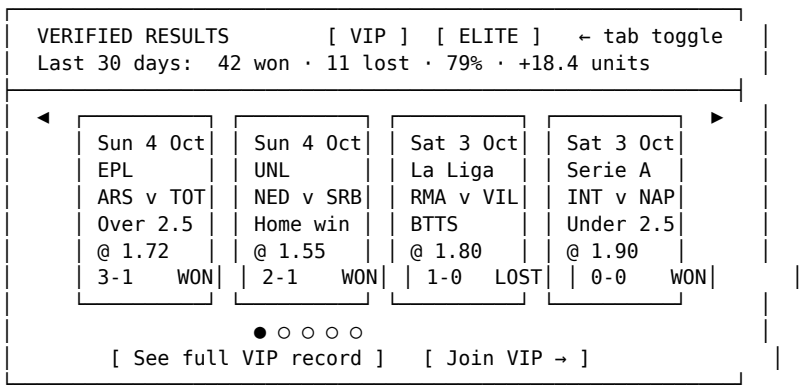
- VIP results = settled tips where **package single ID = `182`**
- ELITE results = settled tips where **package single ID = `178`**

API endpoint (create one if it doesn't exist): `GET /results?single_id=182&days=30`. It returns settled tips, newest first:

```
{ date, kickoff, league, home, away, tip, odds, result: "won"|"lost"|"void", final_score }
```

Only return tips that have finished or been settled. Never return today's unsettled VIP/Elite picks, or the slider will give paid tips away for free.

Layout



(The fixtures in the mock-up are examples. Real data comes from the API.)

- **Two tabs:** VIP (182) and ELITE (178). VIP is selected by default. When the user switches tab, the stats line and the slides both change.
- **One card per tip**: date, league, match, tip, odds, final score, and a WON / LOST / VOID badge. Use green, red and grey. **Show losses with the same prominence as wins.**
- **Stats line** (calculated, never typed by hand): won · lost · hit-rate % · profit in units. Profit = Σ(odds − 1) for wins − 1 for each loss, at a 1-unit stake, with voids excluded.
- **Slider behaviour:** shows 4 cards on desktop, 1.2 on mobile (so the next card peeks in to signal swipe). Autoplay every 5 s, pause on hover or touch, arrows plus dots, swipe on mobile.
- **Last slide** is a monthly summary card: "September: 61 won · 17 lost · 78% · +22.1u", plus a CTA.
- **CTAs:** "Join VIP ->" goes to `/vip` (or "Join Elite ->" on the Elite tab). "See full record" goes to `/vip#results`.
- **SEO:** server-render the first 4 cards and the stats line, with ISR revalidate every 10 min, so Google and AI crawlers can read the record. Add an <h2> that reads "VIP & Elite Results — Last 30 Days".
- **Empty state:** if the API fails or returns nothing, hide the block. Never fall back to dummy data.

Where to put it on the homepage

Current order: Hero -> Markets -> "Get VIP..." -> Live In-Play -> **VIP Results** -> Testimonials -> Pricing -> What We Cover -> Latest News -> About...

Recommended order:

1. Hero
2. **Slim results strip** directly under the hero, one line: `VIP last 7 days: 11 won · 3 lost · +6.2u -> See results`. It anchor-links to the slider. Proof is visible in the first screen without pushing the free tips down.
3. Markets (free tips by market)

4. Live In-Play
5. Testimonials ("Real Members. Real Wins.")
6. **Results slider (VIP / ELITE)** <- main position
7. Pricing & Plans
8. Latest News...

Why above Pricing: a visitor sees the proof just before the price. The VIP tab leads into the VIP plan card and the Elite tab into the "Elite Games (High Stakers)" card directly below. Putting testimonials (emotion) before results (evidence) and then the price is the standard conversion order. **Reuse the same component on `/vip` and `/how-to-subscribe`.**

Acceptance test: the slider shows real tips for both IDs, at least one appears if any loss exists in the window, no tip from today appears before kick-off, and the stats line matches a manual count from the backend.

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2. "Latest News and Previews": new tab headers

What's there now

Tabs: *Latest · American Sport Betting Tips · Champions League · Europa League · European Leagues · FIFA World Cup · International · Matchplug Opinion · MLB · NBA · NFL · NHL Predictions · Premier League · Transfers.*

These are old **football-news** sub-categories. News has been **cut from the content calendar**, so most of these tabs will go stale. The posts the writer is publishing now don't map to them either. For example, **the 6 Oct daily roundup is filed under "Matchplug Opinion"**, and the 5 Oct roundup is filed under "American Sport".

New tabs (match the content calendar's content types)

Tabs to remove :European leagues, American sport betting tips

Tab label	WordPress category (slug)	What goes in it	Status
Latest	(all)	Newest 6 posts	keep
Today's Tips	`todays-football-tips` (ID 163)	Daily roundups + weekend roundup	exists, rename to "Today's Tips"
Match Previews	`match-preview` (ID 157)	All football previews	exists
Premier League	`premier-league` (ID 160, child of 157)	EPL previews (5/week, the biggest slot)	exists
Champions League	`champions-league` (ID 175, child of 157)	UCL previews	exists
US Sports Picks	**new**: `us-sports-picks` (children: `nfl-picks`, `nba-picks`, `mlb-picks`, `nhl-picks`)	NFL/NBA/MLB/NHL picks + US weekly roundup	create
Betting Guides	**new**: `betting-guides`	Evergreen guides (win draw win, BTTS, odds...)	create
Results	**new**: `results`	Monday results & accuracy	create

		recap	

Dev: point each tab at the category's REST query (`/wp-json/wp/v2/posts?categories={id}&per_page=6`) and hide any tab that returns 0 posts.

Editor: re-file the posts from the last two weeks:

- 3 roundups (4, 5, 6 Oct) -> Today's Tips
- The 7 Sep–Sep guides (win draw win, BTTS, over 2.5, reading odds, how sites pick, value betting, beginners' guide) -> Betting Guides
- From now on: **one primary category per post**, chosen from the 6 above.

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3. Internal links: everything the developer and writer need to do

Status on 6 Oct: none of the link fixes from the [3 Oct link brief](https://matchplug-workspace.matchplug.letaido.app/home/matchplug-seo/new-article-links) have been made yet. The full list is below so this document stands on its own.

3a. Dead links (dev, today)

Dead link (404)	Where it is live right now	Link to
`/matchplug-vs-pickwise/`	**Homepage** About block "Full comparisons" line · **Homepage FAQ schema** ("Full comparison: /matchplug-vs-pickwise/") · **/about-us**	/blog/matchplug-vs-pickswise-which-is-better. Fix the label spelling to "Matchplug vs **Pickswise**"
`/best-soccer-predictionsites/`	Homepage "Full comparisons" · /about-us	/blog/best-soccer-prediction-sites-compared
`/accuracy`	Linked from roundups as "full results record" (currently not a real link)	**VIP results page**

Also add 301 redirects in `next.config.js` / `vercel.json`: `/matchplug-vs-pickwise` -> the Pickswise post, and `/best-soccer-predictionsites` -> the best-sites post.

3b. Permanent links to the 7 new guides (dev edits page templates)

Add a link on this page...	...to this article	Anchor text
/free-football-predictions-1x2	Guide to Win Draw Win	win draw win explained
/guides/what-is-win-draw-win	Guide to Win Draw Win	full 1X2 guide
/free-football-predictions-mix-chance	Guide to Win Draw Win	1X2 vs double chance
/free-football-predictions-both-team-to-score	Guide to BTTS	what BTTS means
/guides/what-is-btts	Guide to BTTS	full BTTS guide

/free-football-prediction-over-2.5-goals	Guide to Over 2.5 Goals	over 2.5 goals explained
/guides/over-2-5-meaning	Guide to Over 2.5 Goals	full over 2.5 guide
/free-football-predictions-under-2.5-goals + /over-1.5-goals	Guide to Over 2.5 Goals	how goal lines work
/guides/how-to-read-odds	How To Read Betting Odds	full odds guide
/how-to-subscribe + all 6 US-sports pages (NFL, NBA, MLB, NHL, NCAAF, NCAAB)	How To Read Betting Odds	how American odds work
/about-us + /vip	How Prediction Sites Make Their Picks	how our predictions are made
/vip	Best Soccer Prediction Sites Compared	compare prediction sites
/guides	New block: **"Read the full guides"** listing all 5 long guides + Value Betting Explained + How to Bet on Soccer	article titles

Dev option (recommended): add a pre-publish check in WordPress that warns when a post has fewer than 3 internal links, or when the body contains `class="s17"` (the Word paste style) without an <a> tag.

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4. Crypto casino section + "Top Crypto Casinos by Country" (paid listings)

Adapted from the Sportive23 Crypto Casino pillar and the crypto guide plan. The main difference is that Matchplug's audience is global, not Nigeria-only, so the Nigeria sub-hub becomes one of 8 country pages.

4a. The tree

```
/crypto-casino/                                  Hub: what it is, top 5, links to everything below
│
├── /crypto-casino/top-crypto-casinos/           ★ NEW: "Top Crypto Casinos by Country" (map/grid of 8 flags)
│   ├── /crypto-casino/top-crypto-casinos/canada/
│   ├── /crypto-casino/top-crypto-casinos/australia/
│   ├── /crypto-casino/top-crypto-casinos/uk/
│   ├── /crypto-casino/top-crypto-casinos/germany/
│   ├── /crypto-casino/top-crypto-casinos/india/
│   ├── /crypto-casino/top-crypto-casinos/indonesia/
│   ├── /crypto-casino/top-crypto-casinos/brazil/
│   └── /crypto-casino/top-crypto-casinos/nigeria/
│
├── /crypto-casino/reviews/                      One review per operator (2,000–4,000 words)
│   ├── /crypto-casino/reviews/stake/
│   ├── /crypto-casino/reviews/bc-game/
│   ├── /crypto-casino/reviews/roobet/
│   ├── /crypto-casino/reviews/bitstarz/
│   └── /crypto-casino/reviews/{operator}/
│
├── /crypto-casino/best/                         Ranked lists (updated monthly)
│   ├── /crypto-casino/best/crypto-betting-sites-football/   ← the football bridge, money page #1
```

```
│   ├── /crypto-casino/best/no-kyc/
│   ├── /crypto-casino/best/fast-withdrawal/
│   ├── /crypto-casino/best/new/
│   └── /crypto-casino/best/high-roller/
│
├── /crypto-casino/guides/                    The 20 guides already planned (what is a crypto casino,
│   │                                         provably fair, deposit/withdraw USDT, legality, safety…)
│   └── /crypto-casino/guides/{slug}/
│
├── /crypto-casino/games/                     Aviator & crash, slots, live dealer
├── /crypto-casino/bonuses/                   Bonus & promo-code directory (paid slots too)
├── /crypto-casino/responsible-gambling/      Required, linked from every page footer
└── /advertise/                               ★ NEW: advertiser enquiry page + rate card PDF
```

Rules: keep everything under `/crypto-casino/`, **never** under `/blog/` or `/guides/`.

4b. Country page template

URL `/crypto-casino/top-crypto-casinos/{country}/`

Title `Best Crypto Casinos in {Country} (October 2026) — Tested & Ranked`

H1 `Top Crypto Casinos in {Country}`

9. **Intro (60 words):** answer first, "last updated {date}", and the legal status in one line
10. **Ranked list:** the advertiser slots (see 4c)
11. **Comparison table:** bonus · coins accepted · min deposit · withdrawal speed · KYC · licence
12. **Is crypto gambling legal in {Country}?** A factual 150-word section with a link to the legality guide
13. **How to deposit from {Country}:** local on-ramps (Interac -> USDT in CA, P2P/NGN in NG, PIX in BR, UPI in IN…)
14. **Responsible gambling:** local helpline (GamCare UK, Gambling Help Online AU, ConnexOntario CA, etc.)
15. **FAQ:** 4 questions with FAQPage schema
16. **Disclosure box** (always visible): *"Some listings are paid placements. Matchplug may earn a commission. 18+. Gambling involves risk."*

4c. Paid slots: how the developer should build them

Admin (WordPress custom post type `casino_listing`):

Field	Notes
Brand name, logo, short pitch (120 chars)	
Bonus headline + T&Cs link	e.g. "200% up to 1 BTC + 50 free spins"
Affiliate / tracking URL	Every outbound link gets `rel="sponsored nofollow noopener"`
Countries [multi-select] + **position per country**	So Stake can be #1 in Canada and #3 in Nigeria
Slot tier	**Featured (#1)** · **Premium (#2–3)** · **Standard (#4–10)** · Sidebar banner
Start date / end date	Listing appears and disappears automatically. Email the admin 7 days before expiry
Sponsored flag	Shows a "Sponsored" / "Ad" label on the card (required by

	advertising rules)
Rating (editorial)	**Not** shown as review stars in schema for paid listings. Use `ItemList` schema only

Front end: the Featured slot is a large card with a "Visit site" button. Premium and Standard slots are compact rows. Add click tracking per listing per country (a GA4 event `casino_click` with brand, country and slot), so advertisers get a monthly report and you can price slots on real clicks.

Geo-targeting: read the visitor's country from Vercel's `x-vercel-ip-country` header. If the visitor is in a **restricted market** (table below), hide "Visit site" buttons and show an information-only version.

4d. The legal reality: which countries can actually sell slots

This needs to be decided before anyone sells a slot. **Offshore crypto casinos are illegal to advertise in most of the 8 markets requested**:

Country	Status (Oct 2026)	Paid slots for offshore crypto casinos?
Nigeria	Regulated state by state since the Nov 2024 Supreme Court ruling; offshore crypto is a grey area	**Open**, with disclaimers
Canada	Ontario has its own licensing (iGaming Ontario) and bans ads for unlicensed sites. The rest of Canada is grey	**Open**, but geo-exclude **Ontario**
Brazil	Regulated since Jan 2025: only licensed `.bet.br` operators, and **crypto deposits are banned** for them	**Licensed `.bet.br` advertisers only**, so it's a "betting sites" page, not crypto
UK	Only UKGC-licensed operators may advertise to UK users; UKGC operators don't accept crypto	**Information only.** No offshore listings; UKGC-licensed advertisers only
Germany	Only GGL-whitelisted operators are legal; advertising for unlicensed operators is banned	**Information only**
Australia	Interactive Gambling Act bans online casinos for Australians; ACMA blocks offshore sites	**No paid slots.** Information page only
India	The 2025 Online Gaming Act bans real-money online games **and their advertising**	**No paid slots.** Information page only
Indonesia	All gambling is illegal; sites get blocked	**No paid slots.** Information page only

Recommendation: build all 8 pages, because they all rank for "crypto casino {country}" searches and the information versions build authority. **Sell paid slots on Nigeria and Canada (ex-Ontario) first**, and on Brazil/UK only for licensed operators. Put the other four in the CMS with paid slots switched off. *This is not legal advice. Have a gambling lawyer confirm before the first contract is signed.*